JOB APPLICATION RESEARCH - BALTIMORE, MD

DAP Website Manager Report

What the job really asks for, where DAP is falling short in reviews and on dap.com, what GE Sealants and Gorilla do better, and the demos Jacob East can bring to prove he can fix it.

Prepared for: Jacob East, Baltimore WordPress developer and marketing consultant

Role: Website Manager, DAP Global Inc., Baltimore, MD (Hybrid)

Pay: $95,000 - $110,000 a year | **Posted:** October 30, 2026 | **Oracle job:** 16401

Bottom line: Bring a working product finder, an AI expert chat mock, and a metrics portfolio. That is what the posting asks for, and it is where DAP is weakest.

The short version

DAP is hiring a marketing owner for dap.com and its other brand sites. This is not a pure developer job. The person will own priorities, content, publishing, audience journeys, performance, localization, and the experience that comes through the content management system (CMS).

The reviews tell a clear story. People do not mostly complain about the website. They complain that they picked the wrong product, used it in the wrong place, and then got pointed at fine print. That is a product selection and content problem. A good website manager can fix a lot of it before the tube is even opened.

The competitor check points the same way. GE Sealants puts a project finder on its homepage. Gorilla offers a 24/7 AI assistant. DAP has neither on its new site. Its old guided selector is still sitting on a legacy site. Nobody in this set has a coverage calculator, live store inventory, or an online warranty claim flow. Those are open chances, not catch-up work.

5-7 yrs
Experience asked for, running a complex brand or corporate site.

37%
Share who would recommend Kwik Seal Plus at Home Depot. The weakest flagship signal in the reviews.

5
Demos ranked in this report, each tied to a line in the posting and to work Jacob has already done.

Research date: November 6, 2026. All findings are from the completed research file for this report. Live interactive behavior on dap.com could not be tested, so site notes are based on full page fetches from that date. See the last page for what could not be verified.

1. The role is ownership, not just updates

The Website Manager serves as the marketing owner of dap.com and other owned brand websites. The goal is to keep improving them as high-performing brand, product discovery, and audience experiences.

The role leads work across Brand Marketing, Search, Marketing Technology, product information management and digital asset management (PIM/DAM), IT, Customer Service, and outside partners. It owns website outcomes and follow-through, and partners with specialists for deep expertise.

Detail	What the posting says
Title and employer	Website Manager, DAP Global Inc.
Location	Baltimore, MD, United States. Hybrid. Full-time, day schedule.
Pay	$95,000 - $110,000 a year
Posting	Published October 30, 2026. Oracle requisition 16401. A mirror listing says it runs through November 29, 2026.
Education	Bachelor's degree in Marketing, Communications, Digital Marketing, Business, or a related field, or equivalent relevant experience.
Experience	5 to 7 years of relevant work experience.
Benefits listed	Medical, dental, and vision. Company life insurance. Paid time off. Short and long term disability. 401(k). Employer funded pension. Tuition reimbursement. The company boilerplate also lists parental leave, an employee stock purchase plan, and wellness programs.

Six responsibility areas

1. **Website management and prioritization.** Own the request intake, backlog, work plan, and roadmap. Turn business, brand, audience, and product launch needs into a clear sequence. Own initiatives through completion.
2. **Web content, publishing, and audience experience.** Improve content and journeys. Publish, review, test, and maintain content in the CMS. Keep it accurate, useful, current, accessible, and on brand. Run translation and localization work. Turn approved product claims and assets from PIM/DAM into complete product pages.
3. **Website operations, CMS, and issue resolution.** Own the CMS experience from a marketing view. Document, prioritize, test, and drive issues to resolution. Own requirements for ratings and reviews, where-to-buy, accessibility services, and customer service experiences.

1. The role, continued

4. **Web performance and optimization.** Track key performance indicators (KPIs) with web analytics and user feedback. Find gaps, rank fixes, and check results after changes ship. Partner with Search on optimization and with Marketing Technology on tagging and data quality. Coordinate testing of big changes.
5. **Web projects, agencies, and vendor management.** Lead cross-functional web projects. Turn priorities into requirements, deliverables, timelines, and roles. Manage agency and vendor work day to day, and handle invoices and budget tracking.
6. **Web governance, accessibility, and coordination.** Keep governance, docs, quality standards, and publishing process clear. Lead accessibility planning with Legal and partners. Own the website side of privacy and compliance work.

Full requirements

- Experience independently managing and maintaining a brand, corporate, or similarly complex website.
- Hands-on experience publishing and activating content through a CMS.
- Experience supporting product launches, campaigns, or other time-sensitive work through owned web channels.
- Working knowledge of audience journeys, usability, and user experience principles.
- Experience using web analytics and user insights to prioritize improvements.
- Experience leading cross-functional website projects.
- Strong web writing, editing, and content optimization skills. Able to turn product and expert material into clear, useful content.
- Able to turn business and marketing needs into clear requirements for agencies, developers, and technical partners.
- Able to troubleshoot website issues from a business and user view, and drive them through resolution.
- Strong project management, organization, prioritization, communication, attention to detail, and follow-through.
- Able to manage many website initiatives and stakeholders at once.

> **Read on the role:** DAP does not need someone who can only post pages. It needs someone who can rank the work, run the vendors, fix the journeys, and prove the result. That framing should shape the whole application.

2. Nice-to-haves are the interview map

These are the preferred qualifications, listed in the posting under Preferred. Treat this list as the checklist for the cover letter, the portfolio, and the interview.

- Experience with Sitecore or a comparable enterprise CMS
- Experience in CPG or another product-led consumer business
- Experience working with web agencies and vendors
- Experience managing agency or vendor scopes, estimates, invoices, and budget tracking
- Experience with multilingual or localized web experiences
- Familiarity with web accessibility and website privacy and compliance
- Working knowledge of SEO, AEO, and GEO principles
- Familiarity with PIM/DAM-supported product content and digital assets
- Experience with website integrations or external services from a marketing or business-owner perspective
- Basic familiarity with HTML and CSS sufficient to troubleshoot content presentation and communicate effectively with developers

> **The closing line matters most:**
>
> *"Successful candidates should be able to demonstrate examples of improving website content, journeys, governance, or performance through measurable results, structured prioritization, or sustained operational improvement."*

SEO is search engine optimization. AEO is answer engine optimization. GEO is generative engine optimization. In plain terms, DAP wants content that ranks in search, gets picked as the direct answer, and shows up right in AI search results.

CPG means consumer packaged goods. PIM/DAM means the systems that hold approved product data and digital assets, so every page, data sheet, and retailer listing says the same true thing.

Why Sitecore is real here: dap.com is served from Sitecore Cloud. Its homepage images sit on a Sitecore Cloud host for dap.com. So the Sitecore preference is not boilerplate. It is their live stack. Jacob's honest answer is comparable CMS depth in WordPress, not Sitecore itself. See the demo plan for how to say that well.

3. DAP is a Baltimore company with real scale

DAP Products Inc. makes latex caulks, silicone sealants, adhesives, insulating foams, and patch and repair products. It sells through home improvement stores, hardware stores, paint stores, and pro distributors.

Fact	Detail
Parent company	An operating company and division of RPM International Inc. The posting calls RPM a $7.3 billion multinational company, listed as NYSE: RPM.
Headquarters	2400 Boston Street, Suite 200, Baltimore, MD 21224, in Canton. DAP has had its HQ in Baltimore since 1998.
Plant	4630 North Point Blvd, established in 1974. A 2024 company release said the plant had 180 people and HQ had 165 people at that time. Treat those counts as dated, not current.
Founded	1865 in Dayton, Ohio, making sealing wax for food canning. The DAP name came from the 1957 merger that formed Dicks-Armstrong-Pontius. DAP was first to market with latex caulk in 1964.
Scale	More than 775 associates in a Glassdoor snapshot. Eight manufacturing and distribution sites in the US and Canada. Products in 60,000 retail outlets, per the posting.
Market claim	DAP claims it is the number 1 caulk brand in America. It also claims Alex is the number 1 caulk brand pro painters prefer. These are company claims, not an independent audit.

Main brands and product lines

Alex | Kwik Seal | Dynaflex | DryDex | Weldwood | Touch 'n Foam | RapidFuse | Plastic Wood | AMP

The site groups products into four categories: Caulks and Sealants, Adhesives, Patch and Repair, and Spray Foam and Insulation.

Recent signals that matter for this hire

- DAP marked 50 years of manufacturing in Maryland in June 2024.
- A trade index noted Scott Showalter was named president after Mark Heird retired. The date for that change was not verified.
- The clearest signal is the work itself. A new Sitecore-based dap.com is live, legacy sites are still indexed next to it, and this Website Manager role exists to own the result. That looks like a digital rebuild that now needs an owner.

4. Low reviews: Google is thin, products tell the story

> **Correction first:** There is no big set of Google business reviews for DAP in Baltimore to mine. Anyone who walks in claiming they read hundreds of angry Google reviews for HQ has not done the work.

Listing	What was found
DAP Products HQ, 2400 Boston St	No rating or review count returned.
DAP Products Manufacturing Plant, 4630 North Point Blvd	3.5 stars based on 2 reviews only. No individual Google review texts were found.
Better Business Bureau (BBB)	6 total complaints in the last 3 years. 4 closed in the last 12 months.
Trustpilot	No DAP Products or dap.com profile found.
Employees, Glassdoor	4.0 stars, 86 reviews cited, 79% would recommend in the snapshot read.

The real low-rating story is in retailer product reviews, mainly at Home Depot. The flagships look strong at the top line and weak in the details.

Product	Rating	Reviews	Would recommend
Alex Plus, 10.1 oz White	4.6 stars	10,805	78%
Dynaflex 230	4.5 stars	3,322	Not shown
DryDex, 16 oz	4.5 stars	6,239	76%
Ultra Clear, 5 oz	4.1 stars	2,218	72%
Kwik Seal Plus, 5.5 oz	**4.1 stars**	**2,201**	**37%**
Plastic Wood White, 4 oz	**3.6 stars**	**851**	**54%**
Fast 'N Final, 1 gal 4-pack	3.3 stars	67	58%

On BBB, one RapidFuse complaint said glue ruined a vintage guitar bridge and the buyer sought $450. DAP pointed to a warranty that covers replacement or refund only, and offered $50 as goodwill. Another complaint was blunt: *"The product is inferior and dries up after the first use. The customer service is poor at best."*

4. The same complaints keep repeating

Quotes below are short excerpts from 1 and 2 star retailer reviews read for this report. Each one is under 25 words.

1. Shrinking and cracking. This is the dominant theme.

"most joints have cracked and caulk has shrunk" - Alex Plus

"Literally began cracking after two days."

"Shrinks and turns yellowish in a few months." - Kwik Seal Plus

2. Never curing or washing away. Worst on Kwik Seal Plus.

"The product never cured and every time it was exposed to moisture it turned to a paste" - Kwik Seal Plus

"Cracked and peeled within a day. Following all application instructions too."

3. Mold, despite mold resistance claims.

"20 year warranty and it started molding just after 2 years. cannot even clean mold." - Silicone Max

4. Service that blames the user.

One review headline reads: *"Bad batch high shrinkage Poor customer service. Refuse to buy dap ever again"*

"They said it was my fault because caulk is not meant for but joints"

DAP replies at Home Depot follow a pattern. A templated reply cites label limits, such as no continuous underwater use and no butt joints, then gives the technical service phone number, 888-327-8477. The reply may be correct on the label. It still reads as blame to the buyer.

5. Color mismatch.

A Dynaflex 230 review headline says *"Color Completely Inaccurate"*. Another says *"grey caulk in the tube instead of white!"* Clear products add confusion too: *"Two weeks later, and parts are still white."* DAP replies explain that clear goes on white and dries clear in 7 to 14 days. That is an expectation problem the product page should solve up front.

6. Packaging, reseal, and dried out product.

"Just wish manufacturer would come up with a resealable tip design that works." - Dynaflex 230

For Plastic Wood, under the headline "Quality has declined": *"the last 2 cans I have bought exploded and dried out."*

> **What this means for the website:** No review found complained about dap.com, the product finder, or finding safety data sheets (SDS) or technical data sheets (TDS). Do not claim they did. The honest link is stronger. Buyers keep using products for jobs the label excludes, like showers and butt joints. Better selection help, clearer limits, and clearer drying and color notes on the page can cut that misuse before purchase. Happy reviewers, for contrast, praise easy use, water clean-up, paintability, and value.

5. dap.com audit: strong bones, visible gaps

CMS: Sitecore Cloud. Homepage image addresses sit on a Sitecore Cloud host for dap.com, with product images also on images.dap.com.

Homepage: Pro-first, not DIY-first. The hero reads, in effect, professional-grade products trusted by trades. Modules in order include a TDS, SDS, NOA, and certifications hub, four product categories, Dealer Resources, Top Performers for Pros, and Ask a DAP Expert, which is a human contact route.

What is working

- A top-level hub for technical and safety data. This is a real strength, at least as strong as what GE offers. Do not pitch SDS and TDS access as a competitor win.
- Clear category structure, a DIY audience page, how-to articles and videos, and product pages with features, specs, resources, and FAQs.
- Category pages promise filters by substrate, application, and performance needs.

What needs an owner

- **The Alex Plus product page, as fetched, has no reviews block and no buy or where-to-buy module.** The posting says this role owns both. Reviews do exist in a syndication system. Home Depot and Target label some reviews as from dap.com. So reviews are collected and pushed out to retailers, but they were not shown on the new product page that was fetched.
- **A live contradiction on Alex Plus.** Page copy promotes it for high-moisture areas like kitchens and bathrooms, to keep a clean, mold-free space. Its own FAQ says, when asked if it can be used in a shower: No, it is not for use in a bath or shower. DAP replies at Home Depot also say it is not a kitchen and bath sealant. That kind of conflict drives misuse and bad reviews.
- **Listings depend on scripts.** Category listings showed "Loading products..." in the fetch. That raises a real question about speed, accessibility, and what a visitor or search crawler sees if scripts are slow or blocked.
- **A duplicate FAQ block** appeared twice on the categories page in the fetch. Small on its own. It is a governance and QA sign.
- **Legacy sites are still live and indexed.** legacy.dap.com, cms.dap.com, and fr.dap.com sit next to the new site. The old Caulk and Sealant Selector lives only on cms.dap.com. The legacy store locator showed "No Sellers Found" in fetches and warns that an item may not be in stock, so call first. The new site FAQ gives only a general retailer list. No live, SKU-level inventory was seen on either site.
- **Localization is Canada only.** Canada English and French exist at canada.dap.com and fr.dap.com. No US Spanish site was found, even though the role owns localization.

6. Competitor: GE leads, Gorilla shows the next step

Biggest competitor: GE Sealants, owned by Henkel. A global caulk list ranks Henkel number 1 and DAP number 2. Henkel sells 1,500 or more products in the US under Loctite, OSI, and GE. GE claims number 1 in silicone, in the same categories and stores where DAP claims number 1 in caulk. Gorilla is adhesives-led, so it is a digital benchmark only.

Capability	What the competitor does	DAP today
Product finder	GE homepage leads with "Find the Right Product for Your Project" and five project paths. Gorilla has quick decision guides that match a project to a product fast.	Four category tiles only. Guided selector is stranded on legacy cms.dap.com.
AI and chat help	Gorilla offers an AI assistant, 24/7, that gives instant product picks from a project description.	Ask a DAP Expert is human contact only. No chat or AI found.
Social proof	GE embeds its live Instagram feed on its homepage, with reels and pro tips.	No social feed, customer photos, or user content on the homepage fetch.
Pro how-tos	GE has deep, dated pro guides from 2025 and 2026, with standards and workflow detail, plus a how-to tab on product finder blocks.	How-tos exist, but featured pieces skew DIY. Less pro depth and freshness was visible.
Email capture	Gorilla asks for email on the homepage for project ideas and pro tips.	No email or newsletter signup module was seen on the homepage or categories fetch. GE had none found either.
Where to buy	GE splits retail and pro retailer logos more clearly, then says contact your local store. No live inventory.	General retailer answer plus a weak legacy locator. No live inventory either.
SDS and TDS	GE gives one-click SDS access by UPC code through a Henkel document service.	DAP has a strong top-level TDS and SDS hub. Parity, with a slight DAP edge.

White space. Nobody in this set has these.

Do not claim a competitor has any item below. That would be false, and it would weaken the pitch.

- **Caulk coverage calculator.** Third-party sites own this search. DAP data sheets already carry the math. For example, a 10.1 oz tube covers about 55 linear feet at a 3/16 inch bead in the Kwik Seal data sheet.
- **AR or visualizer for sealants and color.** Paint has this pattern, for example Sherwin-Williams ColorSnap. Caulk does not.
- **Live store inventory or buy online, pick up in store hand-off** at the product level.
- **Online warranty claim flow** with status tracking. Both DAP and GE rely on phone or mail-in steps.
- **US Spanish site.** Both DAP and GE lack one.
- **Pro loyalty program.** Absent in caulk and sealants. The nearby proof is Franklin and Titebond Contractor Rewards, where pros upload an invoice and earn points.

7. Ranked demo plan for Jacob

Jacob East runs captainbaltimore.com and built BLKWORK, a job search site with search and filters. He works daily in WordPress, publishing, product style listings, site search, SEO and AI search, and multi-site operations. Each demo below maps that real work to a line in this posting.

1. Guided product finder prototype. Build this first.

Four questions: project, then substrate, then conditions, then product. Cover Kitchen and Bath and Trim and Paint first. The result must fix the Alex Plus problem in the flow, so a shower project never lands on a product its own FAQ excludes.

Jacob's proof: BLKWORK search and filters, plus the full-site search he built for Captain Baltimore that returns products first, then posts, pages, and events. This hits product discovery, audience journeys, and the misuse pattern in the reviews. It also matches what GE already puts on its homepage.

2. Ask a DAP Expert AI chat mock

A chat demo grounded only in DAP FAQs and data sheets. Lead with the test question: "Can I use Alex Plus in a shower?" The right answer is no, with a clear redirect to the right kitchen and bath product. Gorilla has a 24/7 assistant. DAP has only a human contact form. This shows Jacob can close that gap without inventing product claims.

3. Coverage calculator

Joint length, width, and depth, plus bead size, gives tubes needed. Pre-fill it per product from data sheet and PIM data. Nobody owns this tool in caulk. It is a clean SEO and AEO asset, and it helps buyers buy the right amount the first time.

4. Restore reviews and Q&A to product pages

The review data already exists and is pushed to retailers as from dap.com. The demo is a product page layout that brings ratings, reviews, and real Q&A back onto dap.com, with the top failure themes handled in plain notes on the page, like cure time, clear drying white first, and where not to use the product. This is a quick, measurable win for trust and conversion.

5. Metrics portfolio. Bring this to every interview.

The posting asks for measurable improvement examples. Build a short portfolio from Captain Baltimore work: CMS publishing at scale, product and shop work, full-site search, weekend guide and SEO work, Google Search Console setup, AI search readiness, and daily site operations across more than one site. Show the before, the action, and the result where a real number exists. Leave a number out rather than invent one.

> **Next three, as proposals, not builds:** SKU-level where-to-buy links as phase one toward live inventory, homepage social proof plus email capture, and a self-serve warranty claim flow with Customer Service and Legal. Then a US Spanish pilot for the finder and top product pages, and a pro rewards business case based on the Titebond model.

7. Be honest about the gaps

Gap	Honest line to use
WordPress, not Sitecore	My depth is in WordPress, a comparable CMS. I publish, govern, troubleshoot, and improve journeys daily. I know the Sitecore concepts map to that work, and I would be upfront that Sitecore itself is the ramp for me.
No CPG background	My background is local media, events, and e-commerce style product content, not packaged consumer goods. The transferable part is product-led content, launches, search, and keeping product data accurate across pages.
Agency and budget scope	Point to vendor and partner coordination in his own operation. Do not claim large agency budgets he has not run. Offer the demo plan and roadmap as proof he can write a clear scope and rank the work.

That honesty helps here. The research found real contradictions on DAP's own site. A candidate who names his own gaps plainly, then shows working demos, reads as the person who will catch theirs.

8. Sources

- Job, Oracle 16401: hcwx.fa.us2.oraclecloud.com/hcmUI/CandidateExperience/en/sites/CX_20/job/16401
- Job mirror, eQuest: jobs.equest.com/jobs/MD/dap-global-inc/website-manager-493681866.html
- Company, Wikipedia: en.wikipedia.org/wiki/DAP_Products
- Company, 50 years in Maryland release: stocktitan.net/news/RPM/dap-global-celebrates-50-years-of-manufacturing-in-soenjfjwdv9k.html
- BBB complaints: bbb.org/us/md/baltimore/profile/commercial-manufacturers/dap-global-inc-0011-23014309/complaints
- Retailer reviews: Home Depot product review pages for Alex Plus, Kwik Seal Plus, Dynaflex 230, Dynaflex Ultra, Silicone Max, Plastic Wood, DryDex, Ultra Clear, and Fast 'N Final. Read November 6, 2026. Counts can shift between crawls.
- Employees: Glassdoor DAP overview and Indeed DAP Baltimore reviews. Read November 6, 2026.
- Website: dap.com, product categories page, Alex Plus product page, and DIY audience page. Fetched November 6, 2026.
- Competitor: gesealants.com, its product finder and where-to-buy pages, Henkel North America portfolio page, and a global caulk market top 10 list ranking Henkel first and DAP second.
- Competitor benchmark: gorillatough.com/pro-tips for the AI assistant, decision guides, and email capture.

Could not verify

- Live interactive and mobile behavior on dap.com, including search quality, filter speed, and where-to-buy clicks. The research browser failed, so site notes come from page fetches, not a live rendered test.
- Individual Google review texts for HQ or the plant. Only the plant aggregate was returned.
- Marketing or digital team culture. Employee reviews found skew to plant and office roles. One IT review from 2020 said technology leadership lacked vision and commitment. No digital team reviews were found.
- Hybrid day count. The posting says hybrid and full-time, day. It does not state days in office.
- The start date for the new DAP president, and any absence claim taken as proof. Calculator, AR, loyalty, Spanish, and chat gaps are stated as not found in the pages and searches listed, not as proof they exist nowhere.